

UNIT 10

Map Projection

Unit Overview

10.1 Introduction

10.2 Classification of Map Projections

10.3 Construction of Some selected Map Projections

Learning Objectives

- *To Understand the concepts of map projection*
- *To Understand the classification and properties of map projection*
- *To develop graphical construction of cylindrical and polar zenithal projection*
- *To interpret a various aspects of map projection*

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10.1 Introduction

A Map projection means the representation of latitude and longitude of the globe on a flat sheet of paper. The network thus formed is called graticule. Map projection is a mathematical expression using the three-dimensional surface of earth is represented in a two dimensional plane. The process of projection results in distortion of one or more map properties such as shape, size, area or direction.

10.2 Classification of Map Projections

Map projections are classified on the following criteria:

- Method of construction
- Development surface used
- Projection properties
- Position of light source

Classification based on Methods of Construction

Given below are the projections that are based on the method of construction:

a). Perspective Projections: These projections are made with the help of shadow cast from an illuminated globe on to a developable surface.

b). Non Perspective Projections: A developable surface is only assumed to be covering the globe and the construction of projections is done using mathematical calculations.

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